

Sea snails

Conches, whelks, and winkles are all sea snails. They have shells and can commonly be seen clinging to rocks. Most eat plants, but some eat other small sea creatures.



Whelk

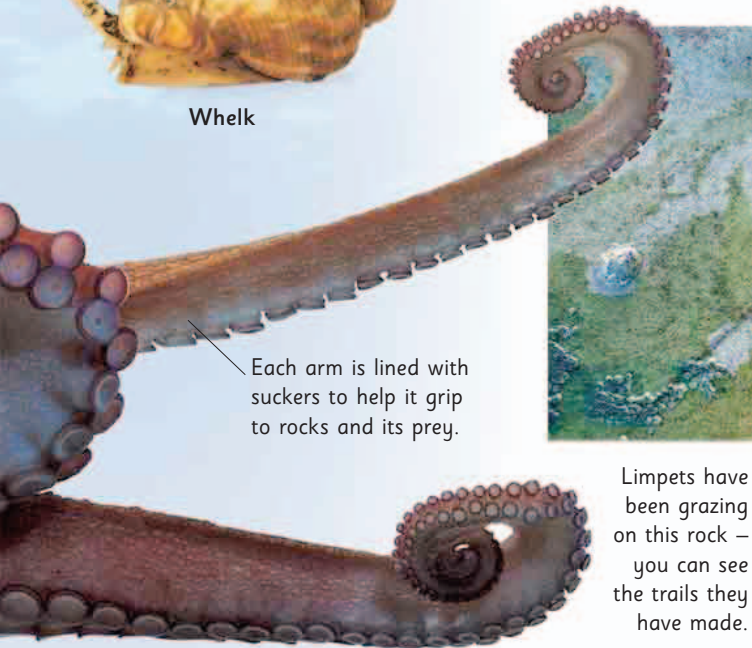


Sea slugs

Strangely enough, some slugs live under water. Like their cousins, they have no shells for protection. Some are poisonous, while others camouflage themselves from predators, such as this lettuce slug.

Limpets

Limpets have cone-shaped shells that protect them. They cling to rocks and graze on algae, a type of plant, wandering around using their muscular foot.



Each arm is lined with suckers to help it grip to rocks and its prey.



Limpets have been grazing on this rock – you can see the trails they have made.



Limpet

Limpets can often be seen in clusters on rocks.

Two-hinged shells

Oysters, mussels, scallops, and clams all have a shell that is hinged into two parts that can open and close. They open them to suck food in and breathe, and keep them tightly shut to protect themselves.



Giant clam

Quick scallop

Queen scallops can move surprisingly quickly through the water. They clap the two parts of their shell together and this movement propels them forwards.



The black dots around the shell are eyes.



Queen scallop

No, but they have sharp beaks.